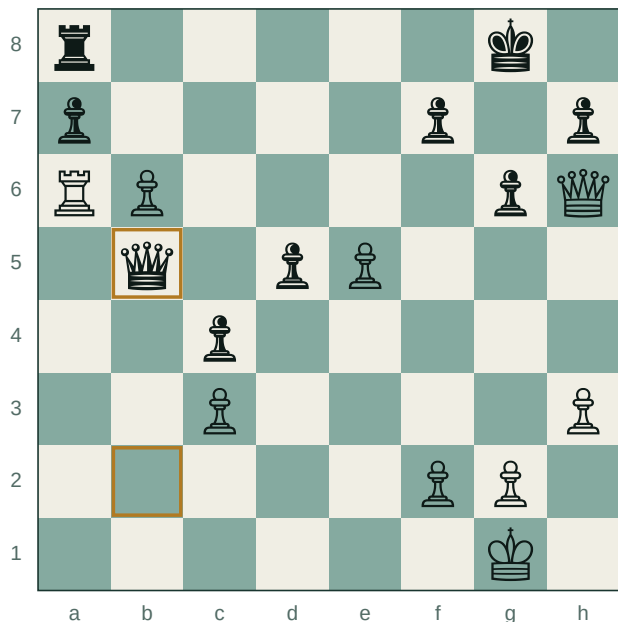


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 28

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...Qb5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Rxa7 Rxa7 29. bxa7 Qa5 30. Qe3

28.Rxa7 The rook captures the pawn on a7. Recorded reply: **28...Rxa7**.

29.bxa7 The pawn captures the rook on a7. Recorded reply: **29...Qa5**.

30.Qe3 The queen moves from h6 to e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on b5. Check for tactical protection.